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ON THE "MISSING" FOURTH STANZA OF CATULLUS 51

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THE third stanza of Catullus' famous version of Sappho 31 L–P begins *lingua sed torpet, tenuis sub artus / flamma demanat* (51.9–10); yet despite the rather close rendering of the first stanza (and the fairly precise translation technique generally held to be consistent throughout the first three stanzas),[1] Catullus here diverges from Sappho in several respects. For Sappho's λέπτον / δ' αὔτικα χρῳ̃ πῦρ ὑπαδεδρόμηκεν (31.9–10, corresponding to *tenuis ... demanat*), Catullus substitutes *sub artus* "beneath the limbs/joints" for (ὑπα-) χρῳ̃ "(beneath) the flesh/skin" and *demanat* "drips down" for ὑπαδεδρόμηκεν "courses under," and omits a temporal adverb corresponding to αὔτικα. While the literature on Catullus' poem and its relation to the Sapphic original is voluminous, most of it concerns the notorious problem of Catullus' final *otium* stanza; few scholars have addressed Catullus' principal deviations from Sappho in the third stanza, or the issue, related, as we shall see, of Catullus' apparent suppression of Sappho's fourth stanza.

Before taking up divergences like *sub artus* and *demanat* specifically, we should consider what seem to be the prevailing views concerning the diction of Catullus' third stanza generally, which appears in full below:

> lingua sed torpet, tenuis sub artus
> flamma demanat, sonitu suopte

[1] See, for example, C. J. Fordyce, *Catullus: A Commentary* (Oxford 1961, corrected reprint 1978) 219: "The three strophes which he has closely translated ..."; Kenneth Quinn, *Catullus: The Poems* (London and Basingstoke 1973) 241: "C. has translated, apparently, only the first three stanzas of Sappho's poem ...; but in these his version, in the main, follows Sappho closely."

tintinant aures, gemina teguntur
lumina nocte.[2]
(51.9–12)

These views[3] concern the so-called "Hellenistic" character of the third stanza, which has been discussed in greatest detail by Ferrari.[4] According to Ferrari, nearly everything about this stanza — including *sub artus* and *demanat* — shows a typically neoteric preciosity that is traceable to Hellenistic influence, as seen in the following features:

1. the postposition of *sed* (*lingua sed torpet*);[5]
2. the use of *artus* for Sappho's χρῶ;[6]
3. the unusual usage of *sub* in *sub artus*;
4. the virtual hapax *demanat*;[7]
5. the alliteration in *sonitu suopte*;
6. the "enallage" in *gemina . . . nocte*;[8]
7. the double chiasmus of subject-verb ordering (*lingua . . . torpet, flamma demanat* vs. *tintinant aures, teguntur lumina*);
8. the "precious" usage of *lumina* "eyes."

[2] I return below to the well-known textual problem here (*gemina* V, *geminae* Schrader).

[3] For a good survey of the earlier literature, see Salvatore Costanza, *Risonanze dell'ode di Saffo FAINETAI MOI KENOS da Pindaro a Catullo e Horazio* (Messina-Florence 1950) 66 n. 3.

[4] Walter Ferrari, "Il carme 51 di Catullo," *Annali della R. Scuola Normale Superiore di Pisa, Lettere, Storia e Filosofia II*, 7 (1938) 59–72. Citations here are from the German translation in the more readily accessible collection *Catull*, ed. Rolf Heine (Darmstadt 1975) 241–261. On the third stanza see especially 249–250.

[5] Similarly (and more recently), e.g., David O. Ross, Jr., *Style and Tradition in Catullus* (Cambridge, Mass. 1969) 68, according to whom postposition of particles (as in this example) "often occurs in a Greek context."

[6] Ferrari 249: "Hinter *sub artus* steht wahrscheinlich eine hellenistische Interpretation von χρῶ bei Sappho." Other commentators either ignore this deviation or treat it in a simplistic or superficial way, e.g., Lenchantin de Gubernatis *ad loc.*: "più precisamente Saffo dice 'sotto la pelle.'"

[7] Ferrari 250: "*Demanat* ist der einzige Beleg für das Vorkommen dieses Verbums in lateinischer Dichtung, und in der Prosa erscheint das Wort erst in viel späterer Zeit." But see below for more on *demanat*.

[8] The perceived boldness of this figure (which is not, strictly speaking, an "enallage" — see Victor Bers, *Enallage and Greek Style* [Leiden 1974] 75) constitutes one of the arguments in favor of Schrader's emendation *geminae*.

A dissenting view[9] holds that certain unusual features (such as the "enallage"), although rare in Catullus, represent possible extensions of his normal technique, to which he was naturally led in his search for the more intense expression he was seeking here, while other features (such as the alliterative phrase *sonitu suopte*, including the somewhat unusual usage of *suus* here) have pedigrees that are as much Roman as Hellenistic.

The truth of the matter is surely more complex: neither is everything based on purely Alexandrian models, nor is everything derivable from indigenous Roman literary sources. Instead, we are likely to find an elaborate mixture of both sorts of elements, in accordance with the highly synthetic techniques typical of neoteric poetry.[10] It is from this perspective that we must approach not only *sub artus* and *demanat*, but also the question of the "missing" fourth stanza of Sappho's poem.

That Catullus suppressed Sappho's fourth stanza is assumed by most scholars and asserted by some (cf. n. 1 above), but the rationale for this suppression is rarely discussed. If there is a *communis opinio*, it is perhaps that expressed by Wormell, in his widely cited essay on "Catullus as translator":

> Catullus' main problem was to transpose the poem from the feminine to the masculine mode, and to transplant it in time and space from remote Lesbos to contemporary Rome. This is no doubt the reason why he omits the fourth stanza of the Greek — it is essentially feminine.[11]

A different (but not necessarily mutually exclusive) explanation is offered by Wills, in his detailed (and also widely cited) comparative study of the "thought sequence" of the two poems.[12] Wills notes, first

[9] See, e.g., Ernst Bickel, "Catulls Werbgedicht an Clodia und Sapphos Phaonklage im Hochzeitslied an Agallis," *RhM* 89 (1940) 194–216, especially 194–197.

[10] On these techniques see for example Wendell V. Clausen's recent study "Cicero and the New Poetry," *HSCP* 90 (1986) 159–170.

[11] D. E. W. Wormell, "Catullus as Translator," in Luitpold Wallach, ed., *The Classical Tradition: Literary and Historical Studies in Honor of Harry Caplan* (Ithaca 1966) 192, offered without reference to similar previous formulations; see already Bickel (above, n. 9) 196; Ilse Schnelle, *Untersuchungen zu Catulls dichterischer Form* (Leipzig 1933) 21; and Friedrich's commentary, p. 236.

[12] Garry Wills, "Sappho 31 and Catullus 51," *GRBS* 8 (1967) 167–197; on Catullus' third stanza see especially 187 with n. 37.

of all, that by "heightening" Sappho's καρδίαν . . . ἐπτόαισεν (line 6) to *omnis eripit sensus* (51.5–6), "Catullus sacrifices (by anticipating it) the climax Sappho saves for the end of her list (τεθνάκην . . . φαίνομαι)"; for this reason, Catullus "cannot sustain and cap the long list as she did. He shortens his list and describes the symptoms he retains in a rhetoric progressively more complex, culminating in the delayed *sed*, the chiasmus of the four verbs and subjects, the *enallage* and alliteration of his third stanza."

But I suggest that Sappho's "missing" fourth stanza has not been suppressed at all: rather, we can better understand Catullus' third stanza as a partial *compression* of Sappho's third stanza together with certain elements of her fourth stanza—a conflation that is visible precisely in Catullus' more salient deviations from Sappho, in particular the phrase *sub artus* and the verb *demanat*, which we can now take up in turn.

As for *sub artus*: far from reflecting a precious "Hellenistic" rendering of Sappho's χρῷ (a dubious and unexplained construct in any case), the phrase is readily suggested by Sappho's τρόμος δὲ / παῖσαν ἄγρει (lines 13–14 of her fourth stanza), a variant of the Homeric cliché ὑπὸ τρόμος ἔλλαβε γυῖα (*Il.* 14.506 = *Od.* 18.88 varied at *Il.* 3.34, 10.95, 10.390, 24.170, *Od.* 11.527, etc.).[13] This correlation with Homeric ὑπὸ . . . γυῖα emerges more clearly from consideration of the Catullan reminiscence *subrepens. . . . ut torpor in artus* (76.21, cf. *torpet, . . . sub artus* in 51.9), one of a number of parallels between poems 51 and 76. Here it can be shown that Catullus' (line-final) *torpor in artus*, like Ovid's *torpor gravis occupat artus* (*Met.* 1.547, also line-final), reflects a Latin transformation of the Homeric phrase, which appears elsewhere in more straightforward transpositions like (line-final) *tremor occupat artus* (Virgil *A.* 7.446, 11.424; Ovid *Met.* 3.40).[14] Note, incidentally, that according to this interpretation, Catullus' *sub* may be justified not only as a rendering of the prefix of ὑπαδεδρόμηκεν (as has often been noted), but perhaps also as a reflection of the ὑπό in ὑπὸ . . . γυῖα.

[13] Cf. Wills (above, n. 12) 174 n. 18: "It has often been observed that Sappho's 'symptoms' are largely drawn from Homeric descriptions of *fear*."

[14] For detailed discussion, including further comparison with Lucretius' (line-final) phrase ***succidere artus*** (3.156), in his well-known and partly Sappho-inspired description of the physical symptoms of fear, see my "Catullus 76.21: *ut torpor in artus*," to appear in *RhM*.

The verb *demanat* "drips down" (in Catullus' third stanza) likewise finds a natural explanation if we grant the possibility of compression: it is, I propose, an almost literal rendering of Sappho's κακχέεται "pours down" in line 13 of her *fourth* stanza, which begins: κὰδ δέ μ' ἵδρως κακχέεται (the phrase directly preceding τρόμος δὲ / παῖσαν ἄγρει). Thus *demanat* suggests simultaneously not only the heat "emanating" from the *tenuis flamma* (Sappho's λέπτον πῦρ), but also its resulting physical manifestation in the form of sweat (ἵδρως)—literally expressed in Sappho's κακχέεται, but merely latent in *demanat*.

This line of Sappho's poem, to be sure, is the locus of a complex textual problem partly involving the form κακχέεται itself. The text of 'Longinus' for this line has the unmetrical (and otherwise anomalous) sequence ἐκαδε μ' ἱδρῶς ψυχρὸς κακχέαται (restored by Ahrens as cited above). This, together with 'Longinus'' own phrase καθ' ὑπεναντιώσεις ἅμα ψύχεται καίεται, has been taken to indicate that he may in fact have read ψυχρὸς (or Aeol. ψῦχρος); hence Page's well-known emendation κὰδ δέ μ' ἵδρως ψῦχρος ἔχει.[15] But Page's κατέχει, to begin with, is not an attractive verb for this context; and even if κατέχω could be used more or less naturally in the way Page claims ("sweat covers me"),[16] it is disquieting that ἱδρώς is simply not treated this way in early Greek poetry: the parallel passages adduced by Voigt,[17] which show that κατὰ . . . ῥέω was idiomatic with ἱδρώς,[18] clearly favor κακχέεται.[19] Additional support for κακχέεται appears in

[15] Denys Page, *Sappho and Alcaeus* (Oxford 1955) 25; similarly G. Privitera (ἐκ δέ μ' ἵδρως ψῦχρος ἔχει), *Hermes* 97 (1969) 267–272, followed by R. Pretagostini, *QUCC* 24 (1977) 111 n. 11. David Campbell preferred Page's emendation in his 1967 anthology (*Greek Lyric Poetry* [London/New York] 44, 272), but has now abandoned it in his more recent Loeb edition of Sappho (1982), in favor of κακχέεται. For a convenient listing of emendations proposed for this line, see M. Bonaria, *Humanitas* 25–26 (1973–1974) 169–170.

[16] The single Sophoclean parallel he adduces (κόνιν . . . ἣ κατεῖχε τὸν νέκυν, *Antig.* 409 f.) is far from conclusive on this point; see the discussion by Privitera (above, n. 15) 270.

[17] Eva-Maria Voigt, *Sappho et Alcaeus* (Amsterdam 1971) 59: *Il.* 11.810 (= 23.715) κατὰ δὲ νότιος ῥέεν ἱδρώς, Theogn. 1017–1018 κατὰ μὲν χροιὴν ῥέει ἄσπετος ἱδρώς; cf. further, for example, *Il.* 16.109–110 κὰδ δέ οἱ ἱδρὼς / πάντοθεν ἐκ μελέων πολὺς ἔρρεεν (cited also by M. L. West, *Maia* N.S. 22 [1970] 312) and *Il.* 23.688 ἔρρεε δ' ἱδρώς.

[18] As also ἀνακηκίω "gush up," e.g., *Il.* 13.705 πολὺς δ' ἀνακηκίει ἱδρώς ~ 23.507 πολὺς δ' ἀνεκήκιεν ἱδρώς.

[19] One may also, with V. di Benedetto (*Hermes* 113 [1985] 152), compare Theocritus' reminiscence of Sappho, ἐκ δὲ μετώπω / ἱδρώς μεν κοχύδεσκεν (2.106–107), in which

the papyrus reading ἀδεμ' κακὸς ἰδρὼς χέεται (*An. Ox.* i.208 Cramer), regardless of whether or not the initial sequence actually reflects feminine gender for ἵδρως in Aeolic (i.e., ἀ δέ μ' ἵδρως κακχέεται).[20] When we consider, finally, that ψυχρὸς and ψύχεται in the 'Longinus' passage need not be taken as direct evidence for Sappho's text,[21] we can conclude that there are no good reasons to doubt what our sources unanimously transmit (directly in 'Longinus' and indirectly in the grammatical citation), namely κακχέεται.

There is no surprise in the choice of *demanat* (as opposed to a more "precise" etymological rendering like *defundit*), given the appropriateness of *manare* with *sudor* in Roman epic diction: note, e.g., Ennius *Ann.* 417 Skutsch *tunc timido manat ex omni corpore sudor*, cf. Lucretius 6.944 *manat item nobis e toto corpore sudor* and Virgil *A.* 3.175 *tum gelidus toto manabat corpore sudor*. Also relevant, however, is one of the "pre-neoteric" epigrams of Valerius Aedituus (Aulus Gellius 19.9.11 = Morel 42), which is a meditation based more or less directly on Sappho's poem: here we find the line *per pectus manat subito <subido> mihi sudor*.[22] To the extent that commentators have taken note of *demanat* at all, its *de-* has been seen as a problem. But if the above explanation is correct, it is unnecessary to speculate (along with Ellis, for example) that the flame "flows downward from the eyes which first receive it." Indeed, the difficulty in interpreting *demanat* has led some (including Ellis) to prefer the conjecture *dimanat*, which is felt to agree better with the diffusive nature of fire, despite (as Ellis readily admits) the complete lack of MS support for such a form. Note further that Ferrari's statement about the late appearance of *demano* in

κοχυδέω is etymologically related to χέω. Note further di Benedetto's observations on the idiomatic use of καταχέομαι with ἱδρώς in the Hippocratic Corpus.

[20] Despite di Benedetto's *plaidoyer* ([above, n. 19] 151) for the trustworthiness of this citation, the veracity of this bit of grammatical lore is far from certain. Di Benedetto's arguments against a double κὰτ in Sappho are overstated (on this point see Bonaria [above, n. 15] 170), and the appropriateness of a definite article in this context is in any case rightly questioned by West (above, n. 17). Hence the most likely beginning for this line is indeed κὰδ, which thereby eliminates the "evidence" for the feminine gender of ἵδρως in Aeolic (for which, incidentally, there is no other historical or comparative support). Thus, although Frisk, for example, records the feminine gender of this word as if it were certain ("auch f. [Sapph.]"), it may just as well be fictitious.

[21] On this point see especially W. B. Sedgwick, *AJP* 69 (1948) 197; West (above, n. 17) 312; and most recently di Benedetto (above, n. 19) 151–152.

[22] On this poem see Costanza (above, n. 3) 37 (with further references), and more recently Ross (above, n. 5) 139 ff., especially 149–150.

prose (above, n. 7) is simply false: the form *demanavit* is in fact attested in Cicero (*Cael.* 6), where it is read by the *Vetus Cluniacensis*, with *dimanavit*—itself a hapax—as a *varia lectio*. Given a theory of conflation, Catullus' subtle addition of *de-* (as well as the use of *mano* itself) is easily explained via Sappho's κακχέεται.

Indeed, the conclusion of Catullus' third stanza (*teguntur / lumina nocte*, or *gemina teguntur / lumina nocte*), which deviates rather strikingly in its expression from Sappho's imageless original (ὀππάτεσσι δ' οὐδ' ἔν ὄρημμ', line 11), can also be interpreted in terms of conflation with the fourth stanza: the eyes covered over with "night" naturally suggest the darkness of death, and so may reflect Sappho's own climactic concluding reference to death (lines 15–16): τεθνάκην δ' ὀλίγω 'πιδεύης / φαίνομ' ἔμ' αὔτ[α.[23] According to this theory, then, three of the four "symptoms" Sappho enumerates in her fourth stanza (sweat, seizing of the limbs, nearness to death) are actually compressed into Catullus' third stanza. The only missing item is the description of the complexion: χλωροτέρα δὲ ποίας / ἔμμι (lines 14–15); strictly speaking, this would be the only element whose suppression could legitimately be claimed to result from some inherent "femininity," à la Wormell's theory.[24] The conflation analysis implies, then, a revision of Wills' explanation for the "non-appearance" of the various items generally claimed to have been suppressed by Catullus: perhaps because, as Wills suggests, Catullus' *omnis eripit sensus* anticipates the concluding reference to death, the listing of symptoms in his third stanza is intensified not just via stylistic means—and only marginally via omission (vis-à-vis Sappho)—but also by compressing, in fairly subtle ways, material from Sappho's third and fourth stanzas.

We may also note, in concluding, that this theory has an obvious bearing on the interpretation of the *otium* stanza. Under the conflation analysis, we can no longer make the conventional assumption that Catullus suddenly "breaks off" from what has been a fairly literal version of Sappho to append his remarks on *otium*. But whether the *otium* stanza is more or less directly related to a fifth stanza of Sappho (if that

[23] Note that the highly marked *gemina . . . nocte* would serve to intensify such a concluding metaphorical evocation of death, which would be somewhat weakened by the emendation *geminae*, despite other arguments that can be adduced in favor of *geminae*.

[24] Cf. West (above, n. 17) 314: "He [Catullus] omits the fourth stanza, whether from weariness of the exercise or from reluctance to describe himself as greener than grass."

is what the enigmatic and corrupt concluding fragment preserved by 'Longinus' represents) remains as mysterious as ever.[25]

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